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THE CLICKETY CLACK CONTINUES

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers, the manual typewriter still deserves a place alongside the computer **P4**



SCREEN TIME OFF FOR SENIORS TOO

In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft **P6**

Rajiv Gandhi Nagar demands its name board

After waiting for what seems like an eon for a name board at the entrance of Rajiv Gandhi Nagar, its residents have now appealed to Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to look into this failing by Greater Chennai Corporation

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

The lack of a name board might seem like a problem one could live with. The fact that Rajiv Gandhi Nagar, a neighbourhood off Old Mahabalipuram Road (OMR), has continued without one for around three decades seems to be proof. But an existence without a name board brings with it a slew of irritants. Visitors heading down the wrong street, ignoring the right one, despite the latter looming right under their nose. Greater time spent on the phone directing the courier person to one's doorsteps. Apart from all of these workaday problems, not providing a neighbourhood with a name board is an insult to its residents, not intended but a slight nevertheless.

Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Youth Welfare Association in Semmencheri off OMR has had enough of a name board-less existence, suffering this ignominy when the neighbourhood was under Semmancheri Village Panchayat and now, under Greater Chennai Corporation.

The Association has appealed to Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu C. Joseph Vijay, through the CM Helpline, seeking the installation of an official Greater Chennai Corporation locality name board for Rajiv Gandhi



The old name board at Rajiv Gandhi Nagar in Semmencheri.



Nagar in Semmencheri.

The locality falls under the 200th Ward in Zone 15 (Sholinganallur) of the GCC.

S. Jayakumar Sekar, a core member of the Association, noted that although the locality has been around for decades, bearing this

name, but a name board has been proving elusive. Even after the locality came under Greater Chennai Corporation as part of the extended areas, the situation has continued.

Jayakumar notes at one point residents installed a name board and that faded with time and had to be dispensed with. Now, he believes neighbourhood's status as a piece of Greater Chennai Corporation should be acknowledged by providing it with a GCC-designed name board, aligned with the name boards in other areas within GCC limits.

"Absence of a board causes significant inconvenience to ambulance services, Fire and Rescue Services personnel, Police Department, postal services, and delivery personnel, who struggle to identify the area," says Sekar.

The Association has requested that the Government and the Greater Chennai Corporation to install a name board that display the locality's name in Tamil and English at the entrance of the locality.

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Dump site near B Canal in Navalur should go, says FOMRRA

The Federation's ECOWATCH group notes that what was a temporary dumping site now threatens to become permanent



HARSHA KODA

ECOWATCH, an ecology-focused group of volunteers under the Federation of OMR Resident Associations (FOMRRA) have identified a blatant violation of environmental standards and a serious disregard for bereaved families.

An unauthorised dumpyard continues to grow and operate on the land designated as a graveyard, situated along the banks of the Buckingham Canal in Navalur.

For the last few years, the residents of Navalur have been striving to shut down this unauthorised dumping ground created by the Navalur panchayat located on the banks of the Buckingham Canal, shockingly situated on earmarked graveyard land.

This dump yard is close to residential communities, a school, the Buckingham canal and the newly planted mangrove belt. Despite repeated complaints to relevant authorities, this illegal dump yard continues to operate and expand.

The dumping ground poses a severe health hazard and an ecological disaster for residential sites and a neighbouring school community, which are just less than



The dump site in Navalur.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



200 meters away, also affecting the surrounding bird and marine life of the Buckingham Canal.

This dumpyard also poses a threat to a total of 12,500 mangrove saplings planted by the Forest Department in the fish-bone model early this year, which is just 600 meters away in Kazhipattur.

Residents and school students continuously face rodents, pests, flies, snakes, and foul odour due to the continuous dumping and decomposition of waste in the area, it adds.

Recently, the waste was cleared only to be strewn along the canal banks, worsening contamination of a sensitive water channel.

The clearing was done to pave the land with concrete—an expense of ₹17.66 lakh—with the intention of resuming dumping operations on a hardened floor, making it a permanent dump yard.

(Harsha Koda is a co-founder of FOMRRA)

Exnora International Foundation, in association with Kone Elevator India Private Limited, has restored the Keezhkattalai lake and also developed an eco park. The lake, located along Pallavaram-Thorai-pakkam 200-Foot Radial Road, was handed over to the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation recently.

The lake and its area were cleared of trash, and a de-weeding exercise was conducted, along with jungle clearance along the lake. This was followed by dredging and de-silting work and strengthening of the bunds.

After the lake was restored, 600 tree saplings were planted along the lake, and a vetiver and palm seed plantation along the lake bund for erosion control was also initiated.

The lake surroundings have been transformed into a clean, green, and vibrant eco-space, promoting ecological conservation, improving the lake's ecological health and raising environmental awareness among citizens, said a release.

Exnora restores Keezhkattalai lake



At the inaugural ceremony of Keezhkattalai lake restoration project.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

In a release, S. Senthur Pari, president, Exnora International Foundation, said the project is an example of how corporate social responsibility, government support, and active community participation can work together to restore nature, enrich urban biodiversity, and create healthier living spaces for future generations.

Other amenities at the lake include children's play area, fitness area, solar-powered pathway lights and aerator fountains, mild steel hand railings, paver pathways, protective fencing and pedestrian cross-over bridge, and concrete benches. M. Veerappan, Collector, Chengalpattu district; S. Balachander, Commissioner, Tambaram City Municipal Corporation; Amit Gossain, Managing Director - India, Kone Elevator India Private Limited; M. Janaki, Chief Engineer, Water Resources Department, Chennai region, were present.

The clickety clack continues



LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A chorus of clickety-clacks from manual typewriters drowns the bustle on Jagannathapuram First Street, which sits in a tract of Chetpet where every house leans into the next somewhat like books in a library shelf. Inside, as young fingers dance over ageing manual typewriters, kept sprightly by consistent maintenance, teacher-plus-owner of Chetpet Typewriting Institute (est. 1975) P. Padmanabhan is supervising yet another class, spelling out instructions to students.

Typing proficiency opening doors to certain clerical positions in government and private settings, being an essential component in certain competitive government exams including TNPSC Group IV, certain categories of Staff Selection Commission, institutes of this nature still thrive. Padmanabhan points out every class includes students who see typing skill as an end in itself. Therefore, also expect those training for careers in law, the corporate world and so on to walk in through those doors.

And these multiple needs keep these instruments going, refur-



P. Padmanabhan at Chetpet Typewriting Institute; and (below) typewriter mechanic S. Thyagarajan.

2006, taking the mantle from his father and running Chetpet Typewriting Institute. The institute operating from a space in Padmanabhan's house, makes the overheads of running it manageable. He notes with quiet pride, "I am a certified high-speed typewriting expert and an official government examiner," recognised by the Ta-

mil Nadu Directorate of Technical Education (DoTE). With 50 students at present, Padmanabhan personally teaches both Tamil and English typewriting; shorthand classes are also offered. His voice resonating with justifiable pride, he says: "Search my name online, you will find it."

Certainly, decades ago, every street probably sported a typewriting institute. Those like Padmanabhan maintain their numbers would have dwindled, but their relevance has not been eroded. And this is why, 20 years after retirement, he continues to fill his house with a chorus of clickety-clacks.

'Rescuing' typewriters

The phone rings, and within minutes, 54-year-old S. Thyagarajan is on his way to 'rescue' another manual typewriter. There is no workshop, no colourful signboards announcing his trade. He is the workshop on the move; and his experience repairing manual

typewriters since 1986 is the signboard. Owners of typewriting institutes across Chennai have his number saved as "ICE". That is obviously hyperbole, but typewriter mechanics such as Thyagarajan are indeed indispensable in "emergency" situations involving these machines, as brands selling manual typewriters have long ceased production, and the old machines have to be kept in circulation. Thyagarajan entered the profession soon after completing Class 10, having been born into a family of typewriter mechanics, his grandfather and uncle particularly known in the trade. The clatter of these machines defines his earliest memories, and he is among a dedicated group of people who refuse to let manual typewriters become a memory. While typewriter manufacturers have ceased production, he says typewriters are far from extinction. "The spare parts still come from Delhi. A manufacturer who started the business when typewriters were in their heyday continues to supply them to this day," he explains.

He notes that around 40 regular customers, including several typewriting institutes still rely on his services. Thyagarajan once ran repair shops which he shut down as rents escalated. "Every occupation evolves with time. One phone is enough now to run your business," he says.

He is a staunch believer not only in these machines, but also what they bring to the table, well sheet. He is emphatic those trained on typewriters make fewer mistakes because their fingers develop greater typing accuracy than those who learn typing directly on computer keyboards, particularly while typing Indian languages such as Tamil. "Even my name has been misspelt umpteen number of times," he remarks bitterly, adding that such mistakes can create unnecessary complications in government records. And for that reason and also for the fact that livelihoods still depend on typewriting institutes, he wants these old machines to continue clicking away in classrooms and examination halls.

bished from time to time. Chetpet Typewriting Institute is not the oldest, but is symbolic of typewriting institutes continuing despite challenges from technology.

Padmanabhan belabours typewriting institutes' continuing relevance, citing numbers and benefits. "There are 4,200 government-approved typewriting institutes across Tamil Nadu," he states. "Typewriting equips a person to type faster and more efficiently. Once you master it, operating a computer becomes effortless."

This belief has had Padmanabhan, now aged 75, wearing a new hat post his retirement as medical photo officer (also known as 'medical photographer') from Rajiv Gandhi Government Hospital in

A plea to the Tamil Nadu government

Typewriting institutes are anxious over a government order dated October 28, 2024 stating that the Department of Technical Education (DoTE) in Tamil Nadu would be doing away with the practice of having typing exams on manual typewriters, shifting them to computers from February 2028. Echoing the collective sentiment of associations representing typewriting institutes across the state, J. Srinivasan of Karumari Technical Institute in Saidapet, told The Hindu Downtown that typewriting exams in English and Tamil should be conducted only on typewriters. He points out, "Besides, the Computer on Office Automation (COA) exam should not be merged with the English and Tamil typewriting exams. Instead, the current system of conducting the three exams separately with a separate certificate given for each should continue. Every year, more than one lakh students take typing exams, conducted every six months. Clubbing them with COA will reduce the number of takers; and that will result in reduced revenue for the government." Srinivasan adds that switching typing exams from manual typewriters to computers will affect the livelihoods of typewriting institutes and typewriter mechanics across Tamil Nadu, which he estimates around 5000 and 2000 respectively. He states: "Associations and federations representing these institutes and mechanics want this GO cancelled."

A Fight For Survival
In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at an old industry that is pitted against new technology

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers since Madras became Chennai, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer



ERR

In focus: Elevator Safety 101

If the lift in your apartment gets stuck often, it is time to check when its license was last renewed

LIFFY THOMAS

In the last one year, how many times have you or a family member got stranded in a lift in your residential building?

Of the 1,540 responses from Chennai residents that LocalCircles received to this question, 48% said they were fortunate not to get stuck; 25% were unfortunate to have that unsavoury experience once or twice.

Just like elevators in public spaces and mass transit facilities such as MRTS stations, those at apartment communities can show their malfunctioning machine side, frustrating residents. When an elevator malfunctions in any setting, private or public, and causes a safety threat to users, who are the entities one pins the blame on?

Going by a recent Supreme Court ruling, the ma-

nufacturer, the maintenance agency and the owner of the premises are jointly liable for any breach of the safety of lift users.

A pan-India study by community social media platform LocalCircles found 33% had no confidence in the safety of lifts installed in their building. Close to 32% of the respondents from Chennai said the lift in their community was maintained by the lift manufacturer via annual maintenance contract (AMC); another 37% said lifts were maintained by a third party via AMC; 20% said no regular maintenance, only repairs based on issues.

Although the Tamil Nadu Lift Rules

Act, 1997 got amended this year, accountability is still raised only after a lift malfunctions or an accident happens. Many lifts continue to function without license renewal.

Challenges to inspection

In fact, identifying lifts functioning without a valid licence is a big challenge faced by the Electrical Inspectorate, a department under the Government of Tamil Nadu. Besides other functions, the department is responsible for issuing of permission for lifts and escalators to be installed and for the renewal of licenses.

As per the Tamil Nadu Lifts and Escalators (Amendment) Act, 2025, which came into effect in February 2026, license for lifts has to be renewed once in five years.

V. Ramakrishnan, chief electrical inspector to the State Government, says they previously used to send reminders to buildings for renewal, but now that the process is "auto generated" they stopped.

Renewal process

can be done online and must be initiated three months before it expires. The average fee for renewal and penalty for late payment is a small sum, a reason why many buildings ignore it.

The renewal process is important to identify defects and take up preventive steps before a compliance report is submitted

"It is not possible to keep inspecting buildings that have not renewed their licence as there are hundreds of buildings with this facility, but based on complaints we do random checks," says Ramakrishnan, adding that the public can bring it to the department's notice.

Recently, when passengers were trapped in a lift at Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station, the department sent out its team to inspect it.

Besides shortage in manpower, the Department is often faced with issues among residents in apartment associations who derail the process for renewal.

The official says that very recently at an apartment in Chennai the secretary of the association had applied for renewal but the president called to complain that the exercise was taken up without approval of a majority of residents.

"In apartments, there is conflict among residents as those on the ground floor do not want to pay for lift charges and renewal, so we are asked to intervene," he says.

For complaints and other issues, email ceig@tn.gov.in and ceig@tn.nic.in



Paying a premium to ensure safe lifts

This gated community in Manapakkam allocates a huge sum every year for the maintenance of its elevators

Casagrand Irene, a gated community in Manapakkam with 295 flats spread across 15 blocks and 13 villas, has ensured lift-related complaints are kept to a minimum by paying a premium for the maintenance of lifts.

"We spend 4-5 percent of our total revenue in lift maintenance, which translates to around ₹ 10.5 lakh annually," says Lebbaeus Denis, secretary, Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association.

Under a contract with Schneider Electricals, the Association has signed up for Diamond Category Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC), which is the highest in the plan, gold and silver being the other two categories.

In the diamond category, all spare parts including battery

come under unlimited warranty. Every year, the company also undertakes a pre-maintenance schedule in which they replace most of the parts in the functioning of the lift. Besides, what is mandated by the manufacturer, once in every two years the Association replaces the batteries as well, especially in blocks where lifts see more wear and tear.

"There are two batteries in one lift, each costing ₹13,000. The life a battery lasts three years but as a precautionary measure we schedule the replacement a little before the cut-off time," says Denis.

Besides checks every month, the community just needs to raise a complaint in a software and in three hours the technical team arrives to fix the issue.

As in many communities where owners of flats on the ground floor complain about paying for an amenity they rarely use, this community has faced this situation. With villas also dotting the community, they have a big voice against spiralling bills on lift maintenance.

Denis feels that expenditure will keep coming but Associations need to find alternative revenue streams. "We have allotted space for digital ads kept outside the lift that give us ₹ 6 lakh revenue a year, this way we are incurring a more manageable expense on lift maintenance and at the same time ensuring residents have little to complain about," says the secretary.



SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

When conversations around screen addiction come up, they almost always centre on children and teenagers. But what about the adults who spend their workdays peering into laptops, unwind by scrolling through social media, and end the day glued to the television screen?

Here is the outline of an answer to that. And it is being sketched by The Kraft Faktor, a small-batch handmade products brand, creating soaps, shampoos, perfumes, candles and home fragrances, that has over time tucked an experience-based initiative into the shopping bag, conducting craft-based workshops, curating personalised gifts and developing DIY kits for people to continue crafting at home.

Deepa Sam and Nabeela Rehman, founders of The Kraft Faktor (TKF), view digital overload as cutting across demographic divides. TKF has inked in a couple of small-batch workshops (Mindful Line Art & Pattern Making and Paper Alchemy - Beginner-friendly Decoupage) for August 15 (11 a.m. to 1 p.m.) at Playbae Cafe in Thoraipakkam that indirectly address screen addiction. For participation, the number of birthdays someone has had so far carries little weight. For additional details about the workshop, DM them on Insta @thekraftfaktor.

These workshops have a philosophical underpinning, simple but far-reaching.

"We are saying: consciously build a habit in your 20s and 30s of practising some form of art or craft every day," says Deepa. "It could be anything. It could simply be cooking a meal or consciously grooming yourself. If these small routines are done consciously, the results are not visible in one or two days, but over time they make a difference."

Participants of TKF's workshops range from young professionals looking for a break from busy work schedules to retirees trying to fill the void that often follows decades of routine. "We noticed that this stage of life often leaves a huge vacuum," says Deepa. "Many people naturally fall into digital consumption."

For the founders, the concern is not simply the amount of time

Screen addiction is disproportionately associated with children and teenagers, adults often being a glaring omission. In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft

Screen time off for seniors too



people spend online. It is the way screens constantly compete for attention. "For me, it is very simply put – overstimulation versus correct stimulation," Deepa says. "On a screen there are hundreds of images and notifications. Even if you are only watching a few posts or one reel, you generally do not stop because social media is designed to keep you hooked."

Here is the contrast TKF seeks to drive home through its workshops.

"When you are creating a craft with your hands, your brain focuses on one task for 15-20 minutes. You are following one process, one sequence, one goal. There is also a natural stopping point. You finish one page, one piece or one step," Deepa adds.

Unlike scrolling through an endless stream of content, craft requires people to interact with real materials, making decisions, changing tack and reviewing the output. Paper has to be folded. Wax has to be poured. Glue has to be applied. Hands move objects, feel textures and respond to the material in front of them. Instead of reacting to rapidly changing colours, movement and notifications, attention stays with one activity at a time.

Nabeela elaborates: "With doomscrolling, you are only taking in information. Every second you are absorbing something new. When you are doing an activity, you are constantly asking yourself, 'What next? How can I do this? Is there a better way than last time?' There's a give-and-take in the process."

Mindfulness is a healthy by-product. Someone who makes things regularly is also more likely to think carefully about what they buy, how they use materials and whether something can be repaired, reused or repurposed instead of discarded.

The workshops themselves are intentionally small, with no more than eight participants at a time. A DIY kit is part of what every workshop offers, making it easier for participants to keep practising long after the session ends.



From a line art workshop; and the result of a decoupage exercise.

Alumni meet at Guindy college



The 1961-1966 batch of College of Engineering, Guindy, celebrated their diamond jubilee at the Alumni Association Hall of the college.

Popularly called "Guindi-neers 66" or G66, the alumni gathered to celebrate their six decades of friendship.

The event was marked by a quiz, a Zoom connect with G66 alumni in the USA. An e-booklet of memories and anecdotes was released to mark the occasion.

An interactive session on preventive health care for senior citizens was also part of the programme, adds the release.

Madras Day: A bird walk at Perumbakkam Tank

The Madras Naturalists' Society (MNS) has planned various events for Madras Day Celebrations 2026. For residents from this part of the city, MNS is conducting a bird walk at Perumbakkam Tank on August 18. The natural wetland and bird-watching site in Perumbakkam is said to have been an integral part of the larger Pallikaranai Marshland ecosystem and serves as an important seasonal habitat for many resident and migratory waterbirds.

Registrations for this walk will open on August 12. Children below 12 have to be accompanied by adults. Registrations is on first-cum-first serve basis, only via link <https://forms.gle/wo2aBdK4fVMsmkpZ6>.

An insect walk at Madhavaram Botanical Garden on August 14; and a shore walk at Nochikuppam on August 17 are a few others walks in the list.

Need help in conducting an



Perumbakkam wetlands. FILE PHOTO

event for Madras Day, WhatsApp 98410 49155

For more details about work-

shops, talks, contests and heritage walks happening as part of Madras Day, visit <https://themadrasday.in>

One year certificate course on entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai along with Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Ahmedabad is offering a one-year certificate course on Entrepreneurship & Innovation. Classes for this will start this month. Graduates aged between 21 and 40 years can apply. Applications can be downloaded from the following link: <https://editn.in/Web-One-Year-Registration>

For details, call 8668101638 / 8668107552.

E-Commerce workshop

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai is conducting a workshop on E-Commerce from August 19 to 21.

According to a press release, the session will focus on different types of direct-to-consumer business model; selection of appropriate e-commerce platforms based on business goals; creation of effective product listings and pricing strategies. Participants will also learn about marketing, customer acquisition, retention strategies, and branding.



Creation of YouTube channel

Another workshop on creation of YouTube channel will be held from August 12 to 14.

The programme will introduce participants to the effective use of artificial intelligence and digital tools for content creation, channel optimization, and monetization. The session will also focus on fundamentals of YouTube Analytics to understand channel performance.

Training in gold appraisal

The institute is also conducting another workshop on gold appraisal from August 17 to 21.

Participants will learn about the differences between karat and carat; methods of calculating gold and silver purity; and loan assessment procedures for gold and silver. All the three workshops will be held from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. at the centre's premises at EDII Road, SIDCO Industrial Estate, Guindy.

For details, call 8668100181 / 9360221280

Exhibition at Lalit Kala Akademi

The main exhibition of Contemporary Now - Edition III is happening at Lalit Kala Akademi till August 25. The organisers invite the public to be a part of this event.

Programmes are happening at Ashvita's Campus, Alliance Française of Madras, Raw Mango, Apparao Galleries and Gallery Veda.



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Pinkathon spotlights preventive healthcare for women in Chennai

The Zydus Pinkathon was held at the Island Grounds in Chennai on Sunday to promote women's health, fitness and preventive healthcare.

As per a press release, the event featured race categories ranging from 3 km, 5 km and 10 km to ultra-distance events of 50 km, 75 km and 100 km. Over 3,000 women were said to have participated in the event, including first-time runners, cancer survivors, visually impaired runners, babywearing mothers and senior citizens.

A hair donation drive was organised as part of the event, where several participants donated their hair to be used for making wigs for cancer patients. The event also highlighted breast cancer awareness through Zydus Lifesciences' "The Easiest Exam" campaign, which encourages women to perform



regular self-breast examinations for early detection.

Pinkathon founder Milind Soman said the initiative aims to create an in-

clusive platform that encourages women from all walks of life to adopt healthier lifestyles and prioritise preventive healthcare.

Nominate a teacher that made a difference

Mission Guru Devo Bhava, in association with the Lions Club of Meenambakkam, invites nominations for the third edition of Vidhya Seva Samman.

The initiative aims to honour teachers who have gone beyond the classroom, inspired their students, nurtured values and made a genuine difference to their lives.

Anil Kitcha, in a press note, says the initiative hopes to build a tradition through which society respectfully thanks teachers and whose influence extends far beyond the classroom and strengthened communities.



This year, the organisers propose to honour 10 deserving teachers from schools across Chennai. Each awardee will receive a cash award of ₹50,000, a citation and a memento.

Schools, parents, students, teachers and members of the public can nominate a teacher that truly deserves a recognition.

The late date to nominate in August 15, 2026. The awards will be presented on September 6, 2026 at the DAV Girls Senior Secondary School auditorium, Gopalapuram.

For details, visit tinyurl.com/vssteachernomination

Essay competition on eye donation

In observance of National Eye Donation Fortnight, TwinTech Healthcare Services, a unit of the TwinTech Institute of Education Trust is conducting a essay competition on the theme "Donate Eyes, Gift Sight, and Give Life." The competition is open to all.

The essay can be in English or Tamil not exceeding 1,500 words, highlighting the importance of eye donation, its impact on individuals and society, and innovative ways to motivate people to pledge their eyes.

Details about the participant such as full name, age, complete postal address, along with a brief profile should be mentioned.

Participants are expected to submit original essays and AI-generated entries will be disqualified without any notice, says a press release. The initiative aims to spread awareness about the importance of eye donation.

The last date for submission of the essay is August 15 by 5 p.m. to the following email: chennai.twintech@gmail.com

The winners will be announced on August 20.

For details, participants may contact Dr. A. Mahalingam through WhatsApp: 97104 85295.

Madras Day: Tree walk at May Day park

To celebrate Madras Day, the Photographic Society of Madras is conducting a photo contest. Participants must shoot images on one of these themes: Chennai Festivals, Architecture of Chennai and Chennai Daily Life. Last date for submission is August 12.

For details, visit <https://themadrasday.in>

Nizhal is conducting tree walks. On August 15, the walk will begin at 4.30 p.m. at May Day park; on August 16 at Egmore Museum campus at 7.30 a.m. To register, call 9445028067

Bring your old zari sari to Rasi Silks

Rasi Silks (Radha Silk Emporium), which was established in 1900, offers a comprehensive shopping experience for the entire family. Its portal <https://rasisilks.com> displays a magnificent collection from signature Kancheepuram pure silk saris to lightweight cottons, Pochampally and Banaras weaves, said a release.

The portal also features a dedicated, premium segment of ethnic wear for men, designed for weddings, festivals and formal gatherings. The classic men's kurta is meticulously tailored from pure silk and fine cotton, featuring both subtle, minimalist designs and intricate traditional motifs.

The portal is secure for online payments, added the release.

The Mylapore-based outlet is having an old sari exchange initiative. Customers can bring in their heirloom, old pure zari saris for evaluation, and upgrade their wardrobes with stunning new drapes.

RMKV's new collection inspired by Japanese culture

RMKV Silks, known for its wedding silks and silk saris, has launched a range of exclusive handwoven silks inspired by Japanese heritage and culture, 'Kumo Korvai', 'Mt Fuji', and 'Sashiko Reversible'.

The silks, known for their pioneering designs and advanced weaving techniques, have earned the brand two national awards, a

Guinness World Record, and several patents, according to a release from the enterprise.

The store has partnered with the Central Silk Board to develop a modernised pneumatic handloom, an innovation designed to reduce the physical strain of weaving while enabling artisans to better use their skills and enhance productivity. By making

the weaving process less labour-intensive, the initiative has also encouraged greater participation of women in the craft, creating new opportunities while preserving the essence of traditional handloom weaving, the release added.

The store is renowned for its naturally dyed silk saris and patented 40 percent lighter 'Lino' silk saris, the grand reversible sari, and the world's longest theme-silk sari, the release said.

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